

Book Talk Questions



PLOT & EVENTS

What happened in your reading today?

Which part stood out to you the most? Why?

Did anything surprise you in the story?

Characters



What did you learn about the main character today?

Did the character do something that felt different from what you'd expect?

How are the characters changing as the story moves along?

Setting



Where did the story take place in today's reading?

How does the setting affect what is happening in the story?

Could the story happen somewhere else, or is the setting very important?

When does this story take place? What clues do you have to support your thinking?

Problem/Conflict

What problem or challenge is the character facing right now?

How is the character responding to the problem?

Do you think the problem is getting bigger, smaller, or staying the same?

Questions & Predictions ?

What questions do you still have about the story?

What do you predict might happen next? What events in the story support your prediction?

If you were the character, what would you do?

Thoughts & Connections ☁

Did today's reading remind you of anything in your own life, another book, or the world?

How did today's part of the book make you feel?

What lesson do you think the author might want readers to take away?

Themes & Big Ideas 💡

What big ideas or themes do you think are starting to show up in the book?

How might this story connect to real life?

If you had to sum up today's reading in one sentence, what would it be?

Try one of these quick retell strategies:

- First-Then-Next-Finally
- Beginning-Middle-End
- Somebody-In-Wanted-So-Then
- Problem-Solution
- Somebody-Thought-Felt-Said-Did

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Did you notice the character acting in a way that surprised you?
Why do you think the character acted that way? (**Contrasts & Contradictions**)



Was there something repeated again and again in the story today?
What do you think the author is trying to emphasize by doing this?
(**Again & Again**)



Did the character say something that gave you advice or made you stop and think? What lesson is the author emphasizing? How could this be applied to your own life? (**Words of the Wiser**)



Did the character realize something important? How do you think this will change things? (**Aha Moment**)



Was there a memory or flashback that seemed important? Why did the author include this moment? What information did you gain from it? (**Memory Moment**)



Did you notice a really tough choice, decision or question for the character? What is the life lesson and how might it affect the character? (**Tough Questions**)



Inspired by Notice and Note: Strategies for
Close Reading by Kylene Beers and Bob Probst